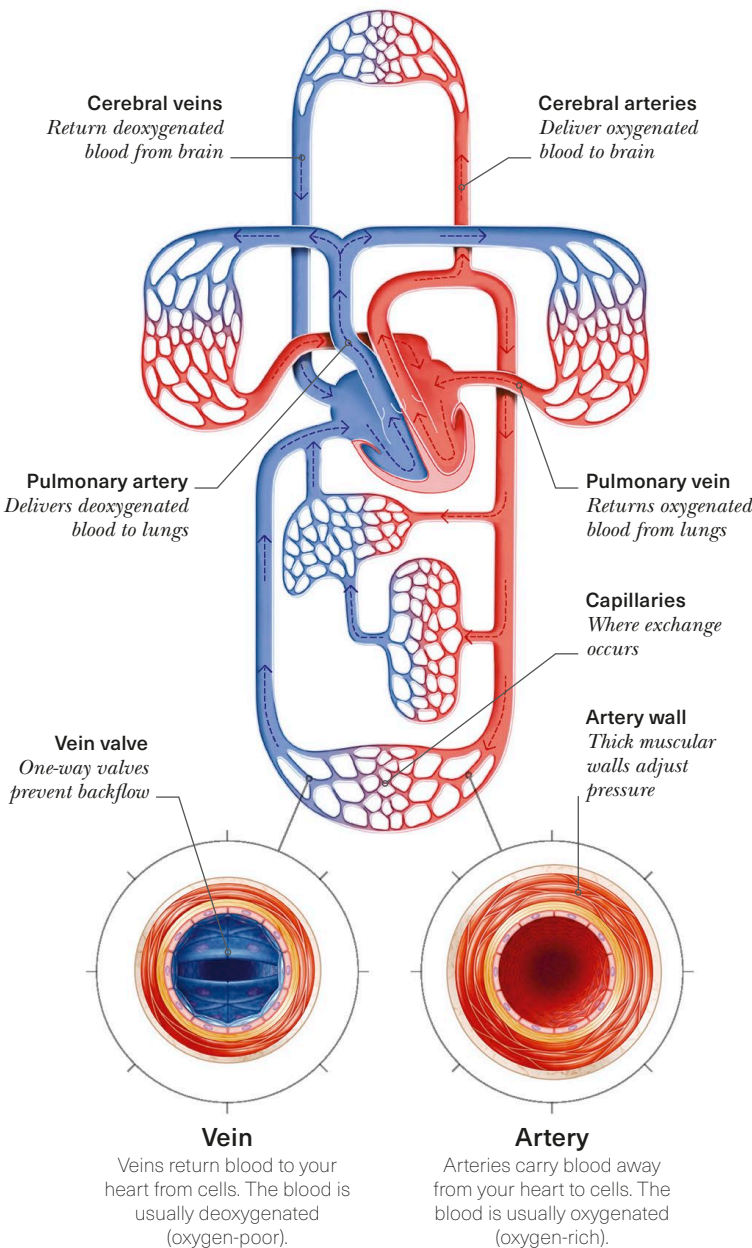


HEART AND CIRCULATION

Circulation has two loops: pulmonary (lungs) and systemic (body). Veins carry blood to the heart, and arteries carry it away. Veins are shown in blue to represent deoxygenation, and arteries are red for oxygenation. The exceptions are pulmonary arteries (deoxygenated) and pulmonary veins (oxygenated).



Heart rate variability

Heart rate variability (HRV) is the heart's ability to adapt fast. It is better for your pulse to vary rather than tick steadily. High HRV shows autonomic resilience and may lead to improved physical, emotional, and cognitive function. Yoga appears to improve HRV.



HEARTBEAT

Hypertension

Research shows that yoga can reduce blood pressure significantly. With more than 1 billion people living with hypertension, yoga offers a cost-effective adjunct to care with minimal to no side effects. Consult your doctor about any blood pressure shifts.



BLOOD PRESSURE MONITOR

Cholesterol

Reports have shown that yoga can increase "good" cholesterol (high-density lipoprotein or HDL) and decrease "bad" cholesterol (low-density lipoprotein or LDL). This reduces the risk of heart disease by preventing arterial narrowing.



NARROWED ARTERY

Heart disease

A meta-analysis suggests that yoga reduces heart disease risk as well as or better than accepted exercise guidelines. Long-term clinical trials have shown that a yogic lifestyle—with asanas, meditation, social support, and a plant-based diet—could reverse heart disease.



DAMAGED HEART TISSUE